THE WEALTH ROADMAP · BY LILIANE

Build Your *Wealth* Without Quitting Your 9–5

Financial literacy for people in demanding jobs

- *Leverage your career to fuel your wealth.*
- *Know your salary and the numbers behind it.*
- *Reclaim your time with your loved ones.*



You work hard, carry real responsibilities and earn a decent income, yet still feel stretched for money and time. This is the step-by-step plan to build wealth beside your career, without giving up more of the hours that belong to the people you love.

7 STAGES | **12** MONTHS | **15** MINUTES A WEEK | + TRUST TRACKER PRO

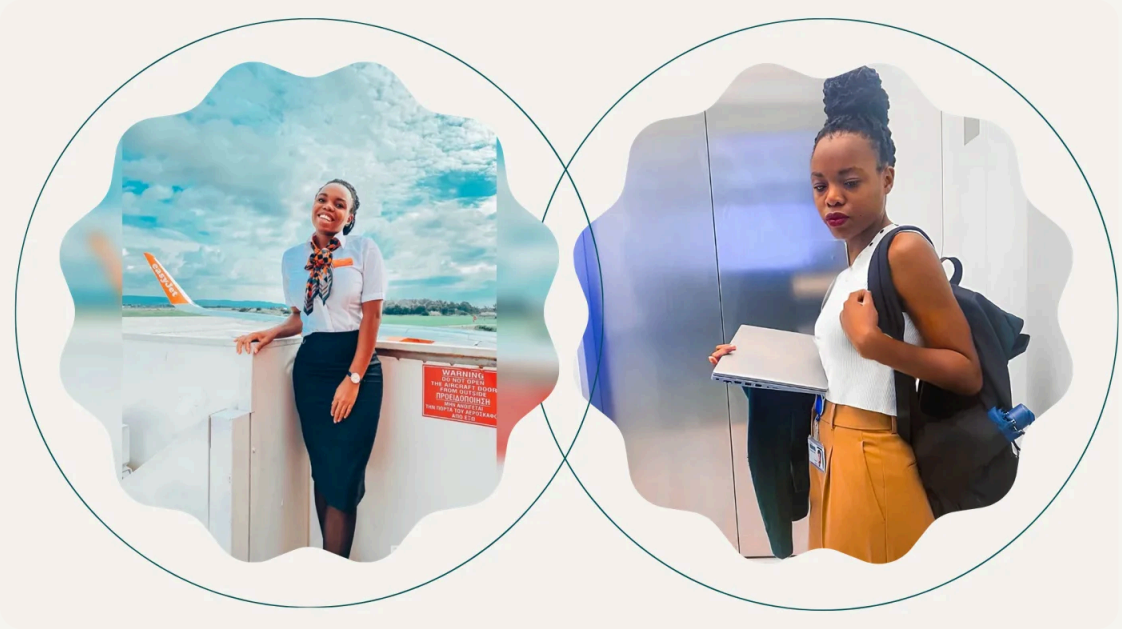
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BEFORE YOU START

Hey, I'm Liliane.

I'm a full-time cybersecurity consultant at a Big Four firm, working in the financial sector. I work a demanding job, and alongside my 9–5 I support my mum, who receives care at home after her cerebral haemorrhage. Balancing the two has taught me how little time is left at the end of a day. Everything in these pages comes from my own life: I paid off €30,000 of debt, and I'm building wealth beside my career with the very system I share here. I don't teach this from the outside. I've experienced it myself.



From the cabin to cybersecurity in the financial sector

You work hard for your money. But is it creating the life you're working so hard for?

You have a demanding career. Bills to pay. People who depend on you. Responsibilities that don't simply disappear when your workday ends.

You're ambitious. You earn a respectable income. Yet somehow, despite everything you do, you don't always feel as financially secure or independent as you thought you would.

Perhaps you wonder where your salary disappears to each month. Whether you're saving enough. How to tackle debt, build wealth or create a second income without giving up the little free time you have left.

And beneath all of these sits a deeper question:

> *How do I build a financially secure future without missing out on the people and moments that matter most today?*

MY STORY

Why I built this roadmap

I know that feeling. I started my career as a flight attendant, working toward my dream of becoming a pilot, until COVID changed those plans. So I rebuilt my path from the ground up, in cybersecurity consulting, a demanding and traditionally male-dominated industry.

But even as my career progressed and my income grew, financial security didn't automatically follow. In my 20s I took out loans for my study fees, made financial decisions I'd make very differently today, and threw myself into trading without really understanding it. I even fell for an online scam. I was earning more, yet I wasn't intentional enough about what I kept, where it went, or what it could help me build. I eventually paid off €30,000 in debt, not by first increasing my income, but by understanding my finances and making deliberate changes. Now, in my 30s, this is everything I wish someone had told me in my 20s.

That journey changed the way I think about money. Financial independence isn't simply about earning more. It's about understanding what you have, choosing with intention, building resilience, letting your money grow over time, and creating options that give you more control over your life.

WHY I REALLY BUILT THIS

My mum is 83. When she had her cerebral haemorrhage, everything I thought was important shifted in a single phone call. I realised how valuable time really is, and how little of it I had left. For years I worked long hours and stayed late almost every single day, because I believed climbing the corporate ladder was what success meant. But true success is realising what truly matters in life, and then taking the steps, one by one, that lead you there. We only get this one life. I want to spend as much time with her as I possibly can. Not someday, but now.

Most of the financial advice out there told me to quit my job, hustle harder, or get rich fast. That's unrealistic for most of us, unless you're willing to risk your financial security. And when people depend on you, that's not a risk worth taking. None of it was made for someone with a demanding career and a mum who needs them. I wish I'd had a clear, honest plan that showed me what to do first, in the few hours I actually had left, when I wasn't already exhausted from work and every other responsibility around me. So I decided to build it for myself, step by step. It's the roadmap in front of you.

You shouldn't need a wake-up call to start. I'm sharing it so you can begin before yours comes, or before it's too late.

That's why I created the free TRUST Sheet, and then this roadmap and TRUST Tracker Pro, which carry you far beyond it. No judgment. No unrealistic promises. No complicated jargon. Just a practical, honest path to make your money work for the life you actually want.

THREE THINGS I WISH I'D KNOWN AT 25

1 · Income is not wealth. What you keep, and what you do with it, decides your future, not your salary on its own.

2 · Understanding comes before investing. Every expensive mistake I made started with something I didn't fully understand.

3 · Time is the real currency. The goal was never more money. It was more hours with the people I love, while they're still here.

IS THIS FOR YOU?

Who this is for

- ✓ You're building a demanding career, but your financial progress doesn't always reflect the effort you're putting in.
- ✓ You're balancing work, family or caregiving, and you need a financial system that works with your limited time, not another task that overwhelms you.
- ✓ You earn a reasonable or even substantial income, yet want more clarity about what you keep, spend, save and owe.
- ✓ You want to move beyond paycheck to paycheck, build resilience and make more informed decisions about growing your wealth.
- ✓ You're interested in additional income streams, but want a strong foundation before taking unnecessary risks.
- ✓ You want financial independence for a reason: more flexibility, more choices and more meaningful time with the people you love.

This isn't for anyone looking for overnight wealth or guaranteed returns. It's for people ready to build lasting habits and make deliberate progress.

The method · KEEP + TRUST

KEEP = Know your Earnings to Escape your Paycheck. Your salary can be the foundation of your financial future, but it doesn't have to define your limits.

- **T** **Track** Know your numbers: income, expenses and what you actually keep.
- **R** **Reclaim** Find where money slips away and redirect it toward what matters to you.
- **U** **Understand** See your position clearly and decide from facts, not assumptions.
- **S** **Save** Build resilience, set priorities and prepare for your future.
- **T** **Time** See how money and time connect, and why independence is really about choices.

Knowing your numbers is the beginning, not the destination. The TRUST Sheet gives you clarity; this roadmap takes you further, through debt, wealth building and additional income, all the way to more time. TRUST Tracker Pro (included) does the maths, shows which Freedom Level you've reached and has a tab for every stage. Follow the 7 stages in order: each one makes the next one safe.

> *Financial freedom isn't about quitting your 9–5. It's about using your career as the engine to fuel your financial independence, build multiple income streams, and create the freedom to spend more time with the people you love.*

Know your money. Build your wealth. Reclaim your time.
— Liliane

BEFORE YOU START

How to use this roadmap

Every stage follows the same pattern, so you always know where you are. Read a stage once, do its steps over the following weeks, and only move on when its checklist is complete.

PAGE 1
The stage
Goal, time frame and the steps, in order.

PAGES 2–3
Deep dive
Why it matters, with numbers, charts and real examples.

PAGE 4
Your tool
A worksheet, script or template to use straight away.

PAGE 5
Checklist
"Done when" boxes and what unlocks the next stage.

EVERY STAGE
Tracker tab
The TRUST Tracker Pro tab that does the maths for you.

ROADMAP STAGE	WHAT IT IS	TRUST TRACKER PRO TAB
Stage 1	Money mindset: your 9–5 is your wealth engine	U · Understand
Stage 2	Know your salary & your numbers	T · Track · R · Reclaim
Stage 3	Clear your debts (optional)	U · Understand · S · Save
Stage 4	Build a safety net	S · Save
Stage 5	Build wealth with smart investing	Invest
Stage 6	Build multiple income streams	Income Streams
Stage 7	Repeat, automate & buy back time	T · Time · Monthly Review

THREE RULES THAT MAKE IT WORK

One stage at a time. Stage 2 (your career) keeps running in the background, everything else goes in order.

15 minutes a week beats one perfect weekend. Book the slot now, and keep it even when it's only 2 minutes.

The tracker does the maths. You fill in the yellow cells, the KEEP dashboard tells you your level and your next step.

YOUR 2-HOUR SETUP · HAVE THIS READY

1. Your last payslip and last 3 months of bank statements
2. Your banking app, logged in
3. A list of debts: balance, rate, minimum
4. Your calendar, to book the weekly slot
5. TRUST Tracker Pro, open on the About Me tab

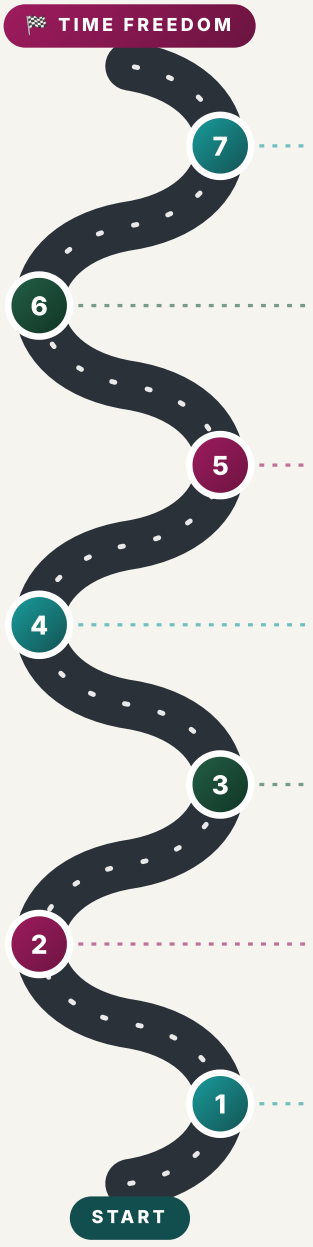
WHERE EACH NUMBER LIVES

1. Net pay: payslip or bank statement
2. Fixed costs: standing orders and direct debits
3. Subscriptions: card statement, app stores
4. Debt rates: loan contract or card statement
5. Pension: your annual statement or HR portal

THE MAP

Seven stages from “where did it all go?” to real choices

Here is the whole journey on a single page. Most people complete it in 12 to 18 months, investing two to four hours a week. Caregiving, illness and busy seasons will slow you down at times. That's expected, and the plan allows for it.



Repeat, automate & buy back time

A system that runs on its own, and hours that go back to the people you love.

TRUST TRACKER PRO · T · TIME · MONTHLY REVIEW

Build multiple income streams

One stream, one 90-day test, built in the hours you can truly protect.

TRUST TRACKER PRO · INCOME STREAMS

Build wealth with smart investing

Compound growth, costs, risk and red flags. Only invest in what you understand.

TRUST TRACKER PRO · INVEST

Build a safety net

A full emergency fund of 3–6 months of needs, goal pots and an automated payday.

TRUST TRACKER PRO · S · SAVE

Clear your debts *optional*

A small starter buffer first, then the most expensive debt. No debt? Go to Stage 4.

TRUST TRACKER PRO · U · UNDERSTAND · S · SAVE

Know your salary & your numbers

What you really keep, where it leaks, and how to grow the number at the top.

TRUST TRACKER PRO · T · TRACK · R · RECLAIM

Money mindset: your 9–5 is your wealth engine

The five laws of money, your real hourly value and why your salary is your biggest asset.

TRUST TRACKER PRO · U · UNDERSTAND

Running underneath every stage: the **15-minute weekly money check** and the **monthly review** (page 09).

map

YOUR AGENDA

Every stage, page by page

Every stage has the same parts: the steps, deep dives, a tool to fill in and a checklist that unlocks the next stage.

★ Before you start

READ ONCE · ABOUT 30 MINUTES

02	READ	Hey, I'm Liliane.
03	READ	Why I built this roadmap
04	READ	Who this is for
05	READ	How to use this roadmap
06	READ	Seven stages from "where did it all go?" to real choices
08	READ	The Freedom Ladder
09	READ	Your rhythm: small, regular, forgiving
10	READ	What the research says

1 Money mindset: your 9–5 is your wealth engine

WEEK 1

11	THE STAGE	Money mindset: your 9–5 is your wealth engine
12	DEEP DIVE	Wealth starts with your mindset
13	DEEP DIVE	Your career is your wealth engine
14	YOUR TOOL	Your real hourly value & your money story
15	CHECKLIST	Done when · tick off and unlock the next stage

2 Know your salary & your numbers

WEEKS 1–4

16	THE STAGE	Know your salary & your numbers
17	DEEP DIVE	Your first money snapshot
18	DEEP DIVE	Grow the number at the top
19	YOUR TOOL	Your win file & salary conversation
20	CHECKLIST	Done when · tick off and unlock the next stage

3 Clear your debts

MONTHS 2–5 · OPTIONAL

21	THE STAGE	Clear your debts
22	DEEP DIVE	The maths that sets you free
23	DEEP DIVE	Not all debt is the same
24	YOUR TOOL	Your debt payoff plan
25	CHECKLIST	Done when · tick off and unlock the next stage

4 Build a safety net

MONTHS 3–9

26	THE STAGE	Build a safety net
27	DEEP DIVE	How big should your safety net be?
28	DEEP DIVE	Your automated payday
29	YOUR TOOL	Your emergency buffer calculator
30	CHECKLIST	Done when · tick off and unlock the next stage

5 Build wealth with smart investing

MONTHS 8–12

31	THE STAGE	Build wealth with smart investing
32	DEEP DIVE	Time is the strongest ingredient
33	DEEP DIVE	Every day you wait has a price
34	DEEP DIVE	Inflation, risk and red flags
35	YOUR TOOL	Only invest in what you understand
36	CHECKLIST	Done when · tick off and unlock the next stage

6 Build multiple income streams

MONTHS 6–12

37	THE STAGE	Build multiple income streams
38	DEEP DIVE	Your 90-day income stream test
39	DEEP DIVE	One offer on one page
40	YOUR TOOL	Your 90-day test, week by week
41	CHECKLIST	Done when · tick off and unlock the next stage

7 Repeat, automate & buy back time

MONTH 12 ONWARD

42	THE STAGE	Repeat, automate & buy back time
43	DEEP DIVE	Put a number on your freedom
44	DEEP DIVE	Weekly, monthly, yearly: the rhythm that lasts
45	DEEP DIVE	Automate everything you can
46	YOUR TOOL	Your buy-back-time list
47	CHECKLIST	Done when · tick off and unlock the next stage

🏁 Your year & next steps

KEEP COMING BACK

48	PLAN	The 12-month plan
49	PLAN	Seven traps for busy people, and the fix for each
50	PLAN	Your money glossary
51	PLAN	Start small. Start today.

WHERE YOU ARE NOW

The Freedom Ladder

Freedom isn't a single finish line. It's seven levels, and each one gives you a little more room to breathe. Your TRUST Tracker Pro works out your level automatically on the KEEP dashboard, so you only ever need to focus on the next rung.

LEVEL 6 **Free to choose**	Extra income covers all of your needs. Work becomes a choice you make on your own terms.
LEVEL 5 **Flexible**	Extra income covers at least 25% of your needs. You could drop overtime or ask for a shorter week. **Work on:** Stage 7, time.
LEVEL 4 **Secure**	A full emergency fund of 3–6 months of needs. You could survive a job loss or a care emergency. **Work on:** Stages 5–6, investing and one stream.
LEVEL 3 **Debt-free**	Consumer debt (cards, overdraft, buy-now-pay-later) is gone. That interest is now yours. **Work on:** Stage 4, full fund.
LEVEL 2 **Buffered**	One month of needs saved. A broken washing machine is an annoyance, not a crisis. **Work on:** Stage 3, debt.
LEVEL 1 **Stable**	What you keep is €0 or more. No more sliding backwards. **Work on:** Stage 3, starter buffer.
LEVEL 0 **Overwhelmed**	More goes out than comes in. Every month ends in the red or on the credit card. **Work on:** Stages 1–2.

ANSWER IN ORDER · STOP AT THE FIRST "NO"	IF NO, YOU ARE AT
Do you keep €0 or more at the end of a normal month?	Level 0 · Overwhelmed
Do you have one month of needs saved, separately?	Level 1 · Stable
Is your consumer debt (cards, overdraft, BNPL) at €0?	Level 2 · Buffered
Is your full emergency fund (3–6 months of needs) saved?	Level 3 · Debt-free
Does extra income cover at least 25% of your needs?	Level 4 · Secure
Does extra income cover all of your needs?	Level 5 · Flexible
All yes?	Level 6 · Free to choose

Find your level in 60 seconds. TRUST Tracker Pro runs exactly this test on the KEEP dashboard every time you update your numbers, so you never have to work it out by hand again.

HOW TO FIT THIS INTO A FULL LIFE

Your rhythm: small, regular, forgiving

You don't need free weekends. You need one fixed slot that survives even a difficult week. Choose yours now and put it in your calendar as a recurring appointment with yourself.

EVERY WEEK · 15 MINUTES

The weekly money check

1. Open the KEEP dashboard. Look at one number: what you keep.
2. Add any new costs or income to T · Track.
3. Move this week's saving or debt payment.
4. Do the next step from your current stage.

EVERY MONTH · 30 MINUTES

The monthly review

1. Copy the KEEP numbers into Monthly Review.
2. Check your Freedom Level. Did it move?
3. Write one win, however small.
4. Choose the next month's single focus.

FOR HEAVY WEEKS

The 2-minute minimum

A hospital appointment, a deadline, a sick child, a week when caring takes everything you have. In weeks like these, open the tracker, glance at what you keep, and close it again. That still counts. The plan is designed to pause without breaking, and every stage has its own heavy-week version.

YOUR TIME BUDGET	WHAT IT'S FOR
Stages 1–2	15 min a week plus one 2-hour setup session, and 5 minutes on Fridays for your win file.
Stages 3–5	15–30 min a week for transfers and debt, plus 1 hour a week of learning about investing.
Stages 6–7	2–4 protected hours a week, in two blocks. Never taken from sleep or family time first.

GOOD SLOTS FOR BUSY PEOPLE

1. Sunday evening, before the week starts
2. Payday lunch break
3. The commute home (on the train, not driving)
4. Friday, right after you update your win file

MAKE IT STICK

1. Same day, same time, as a recurring appointment
2. Pair it with something you enjoy: tea, music
3. Tell one person when your slot is
4. Tick it off in Monthly Review

WHY THIS SYSTEM WORKS

What the research says

Nothing in this roadmap relies on willpower alone. Each habit is built on findings from behavioural economics and psychology, so the system keeps working on the days you're tired.

1 in 3

Only about a third of adults worldwide are financially literate. In Germany it's around two thirds, which still leaves one in three people without the basics. Money management is learned, not inherited.

S&P Global FinLit Survey (Klapper, Lusardi & van Oudheusden, 2015)

≈13 IQ pts

Worrying about money uses up mental bandwidth. In one study, financial worry reduced cognitive performance by roughly the equivalent of 13 IQ points. That's why this plan automates decisions instead of relying on how you feel.

Mani, Mullainathan, Shafir & Zhao, Science (2013)

66 days

On average it took 66 days for a new daily behaviour to become automatic, with a range from 18 to 254 days. Missing a single day didn't derail the habit.

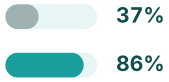
Lally et al., European Journal of Social Psychology (2010)

d = 0.65

Plans written as “if X happens, then I'll do Y” had a medium-to-large effect on reaching goals across 94 studies. You'll write your own if-then rules in Stage 4.

Gollwitzer & Sheeran, meta-analysis (2006)

AUTOMATION BEATS WILLPOWER



Share of new employees saving in a workplace pension (Madrian & Shea, 2001).

PRE-COMMITTING FUTURE RAISES



Average saving rate with “Save More Tomorrow” (Thaler & Benartzi, 2004).

Studies are summarised in plain language; most were run in the US or across many countries. They show what tends to work for most people, not a guarantee for any individual.

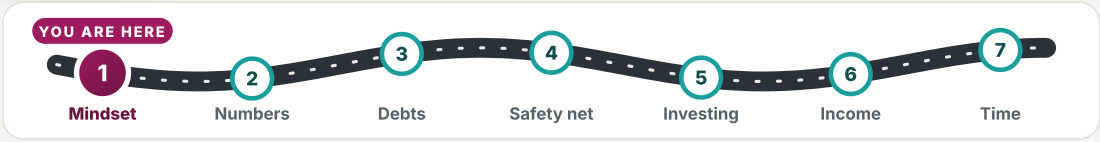
WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR PLAN

1. Learn the basics once: Stage 1 and the glossary
2. Automate decisions, so worry doesn't make them
3. Expect about two months before habits feel easy
4. Keep it simple: one number, one focus, one stream

BUILT INTO THIS ROADMAP

1. Payday transfers instead of willpower
2. A 15-minute weekly rhythm
3. A heavy-week version on every stage
4. Checklists you can see, not feelings you guess

STAGE 1 WEEK 1 FOUNDATION



Money mindset: your 9–5 is your wealth engine

Pillar 1 · Career & Pillar 2 · Financial literacy

Before you track a single euro, change how you look at the one you already earn. Your salary isn't only what pays the bills. It's the engine that can fund your safety, your investments and, later, your time. This stage takes about two hours, spread over one week.

01
WRITE YOUR MONEY WHY
One sentence: who do you want more time and security for, and why? Put it where you'll see it every week.

02
NAME YOUR MONEY STORY
What did you learn about money growing up? Write down one belief that still drives your choices.

03
LEARN THE FIVE LAWS
Read page 12 once. Every stage of this roadmap puts one of these laws into practice.

04
SWAP ONE OLD THOUGHT
Pick one "old thinking" line from page 12 and write its wealth-mindset version on a sticky note.

05
FIND YOUR REAL HOURLY VALUE
Net pay divided by your real hours, including overtime and commute. The tool on page 14 shows you how.

06
SEE YOUR SALARY AS AN ASSET
Multiply your yearly net pay by the years you'll still work. That number is the engine you're protecting.

07
DECIDE WHAT A RAISE IS FOR
Before the next one arrives, decide where it goes: buffer, debt, investing or time. Not your lifestyle first.

08
BOOK YOUR WEEKLY SLOT
A recurring 15-minute appointment with yourself. Same day, same time, every week.

HEAVY-WEEK VERSION
Write your money why in one sentence and stop there. That sentence is enough to carry you into Stage 2.

YOUR 15 MINUTES THIS WEEK
Read the five laws on page 12, then fill in the hourly-value tool on page 14 with a pen.

✓ 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN
✓ Open your banking app and look at your last payslip. Write down your exact net pay. That's your engine's output.

STAGE 1 · DEEP DIVE MINDSET

BEFORE THE NUMBERS

Wealth starts with your mindset

Becoming wealthy doesn't begin with a stock tip or a side hustle. It begins with how you think about money, and with a few simple laws that work the same for everyone, whatever you earn. I learned them late. You don't have to.

OLD THINKING

1. *"I'm just bad with money."*
2. *"I'll start when I earn more."*
3. *"A raise means I can spend more."*
4. *"Investing is gambling, or a way to get rich fast."*
5. *"Wealth means working even harder."*

WEALTH MINDSET

1. *"I'm learning to manage money. It's a skill."*
2. *"I start with what I earn today."*
3. *"Every raise gets a job before I spend it."*
4. *"I only invest in what I understand, for the long term."*
5. *"Wealth means more time with the people I love."*

The five laws of money

1. **Spend less than you earn.** The gap between the two is where all wealth begins. STAGE 2
2. **Pay yourself first.** Your future gets paid on payday, before your bills and your wants. KEEP YOUR FIRST HOUR
3. **Protect what you have.** A safety net and no expensive debt keep one bad month from undoing years. STAGES 3–4
4. **Make your money work for you.** Your salary grows when you work. Your investments grow while you sleep. STAGES 5–6
5. **Give it time.** Compound growth rewards patience far more than intelligence or luck. PAGE 32

Every stage of this roadmap puts one of these laws into practice. Whenever you feel lost, return to this page.

✔ PRACTISE THE LAWS THIS WEEK

✔ Pick law 1 or 2 and do one thing about it before Sunday: move €20 to savings on payday, or skip one want and write down what you kept. Small proof beats big intentions.

STAGE 1 · DEEP DIVE YOUR ENGINE

Your career is your wealth engine

A raise is the highest-paid hour of work you'll ever do

One good salary conversation can be worth more than years of side hustling. Here's what a €300 net monthly raise is worth when it's spent, compared with when it's invested.

A €300 NET MONTHLY RAISE · SPENT VS INVESTED AT 5% A YEAR



Over 20 years you'd receive €72,000 of extra salary either way. Invested monthly at a hypothetical 5%, it could grow to around €123,000. Illustration only; returns aren't guaranteed.

YOUR SALARY IS AN ASSET

€2,500 net a month × 12 × 30 working years = **€900,000**. For most people, their earning power is worth more than any house or investment they'll ever own. That's why Stage 2 grows it and Stage 4 protects it.

PROTECT THE ENGINE

1. Your health and sleep: no plan survives burnout
2. One skill a year your market pays for
3. Five people who'd recommend you
4. An updated CV, even when you're happy

In my world of cybersecurity in the financial sector, certifications and visible expertise are often what open the door to higher pay. Whatever your field, find out which skill your market rewards most, and invest in that one first.

THREE WAYS TO GROW YOUR ENGINE THIS YEAR

1. A salary review with evidence (your win file, Stage 2)
2. One skill or certification your market pays more for
3. A bigger role, project or internal move, even sideways

BEFORE YOU ASK, CHECK

1. Your market range: salary surveys, job ads, recruiters
2. What a new title would pay elsewhere
3. Benefits worth money: pension, training, remote days
4. When budgets are set in your company

IF YOU'RE NOT READY TO ASK YET

Start the win file today. In three months you'll have twelve wins with numbers, and the conversation writes itself.

Ask for feedback first: "What would make me ready for the next level?" That answer is your plan.

Decide now where the raise goes when it comes: buffer, debt, investing or time.

STAGE 1 · YOUR TOOL WORKSHEET

Your real hourly value & your money story

Two numbers and three sentences that change every decision after this

Most people only know their salary. Almost nobody knows what one hour of their life is really paid. Once you do, every purchase, every overtime evening and every side project looks different.

YOUR REAL HOURLY VALUE

Real hours a month = (contract hours + unpaid overtime + commute) × 52 ÷ 12
e.g. (39 + 4 + 5) × 52 ÷ 12 = 208 hours

Real hourly value = net pay a month ÷ real hours a month
e.g. €2,500 ÷ 208 = €12.02 an hour

Keep your first hour = real hourly value × workdays a month
e.g. €12.02 × 21 = about €252 a month, paid to your future first

THE REAL COST OF A PURCHASE

€2,500 net ÷ 208 real hours a month = **€12 per hour**. A €120 pair of shoes costs you **10 hours** of your life. Before any purchase over €50, ask: is it worth those hours?

MINE, FILLED IN

Net pay: €_____ ÷ real hours: _____ = **€_____ an hour**
First hour a month: €_____
The purchase I'll think twice about:
_____

YOUR MONEY STORY · ANSWER HONESTLY

1. Growing up, money was mostly talked about as... _____
2. The belief that still holds me back is... _____
3. The wealth-mindset version I'll practise instead is... _____
4. My money why: I want more time and security for _____ because _____

PRICE	AT €12 AN HOUR, IT COSTS YOU	WORTH IT?
€4 coffee to go	20 minutes	☐ yes ☐ no
€60 dinner out	5 hours	☐ yes ☐ no
€120 pair of shoes	10 hours	☐ yes ☐ no
€900 new phone	75 hours, almost two working weeks	☐ yes ☐ no
€1,500 family holiday	125 hours	☐ yes ☐ no

Some things are worth every hour, like the holiday with your family. The point isn't to say no to everything, it's to say yes on purpose.

STAGE 1 · CHECKLIST

DONE WHEN



Money mindset · done when

Tick every box before you move on. Slow is fine. Skipping is what costs money.

Each box is something you can see, not something you feel. When all of them are ticked, write today's date here: _____.

- [ ] I wrote my money why in one sentence and put it where I see it.
- [ ] I know my real hourly value and my “first hour” amount.
- [ ] I read the five laws of money and picked one old thought to replace.
- [ ] I know what my salary is worth over my working life.
- [ ] I decided where my next raise goes before it arrives.
- [ ] My 15-minute weekly money check is in my calendar.

WRITE IT DOWN

1. The one sentence I want to remember from this stage...
2. The day and time of my weekly money check...
3. One person I'll tell about my plan...

NEXT STAGE UNLOCKS WHEN

You can say in one sentence why you're doing this, and your weekly slot is booked.

COMMON MISTAKES AT THIS STAGE

- Skipping the money why because it feels “soft”
- Calculating hourly value with contract hours only
- Waiting for a calm week to start

LILIANE'S TIP

- Your why is what gets you through heavy weeks. Write it first.
- Count overtime and commute: that's your real hour.
- Start this week, with 15 minutes.

STAGE 2 WEEKS 1–4 GOAL: LEVEL 1



Know your salary & your numbers

Pillar 2 · Financial literacy & TRUST: Track, Reclaim, Understand

You can't build wealth on numbers you avoid looking at. This stage is about clarity, not about giving up everything you enjoy. Most people discover €50–150 a month they never knew they were losing.

01
DO THE 2-HOUR SETUP
Download last month's bank and card statements. Book two hours, make a coffee, open T · Track.

02
LIST EVERY EURO IN
Net salary, benefits and allowances, any side income. Monthly amounts; divide yearly ones by 12.

03
SORT EVERY EURO OUT
Mark each cost Need or Want. Care costs, childcare and debt minimums are Needs. Be honest, not harsh.

04
FIND YOUR BASELINE
Your Needs total is what your life really costs. It becomes your freedom number later.

05
HUNT THE LEAKS
In R · Reclaim, list every subscription, fee and contract. Decide Keep, Cut, Reduce or Renegotiate.

06
MAKE ONE CALL
Phone, internet, insurance: ask for the current tariff or a loyalty discount. One call often saves €10–20 a month.

07
KNOW YOUR REAL HOURLY VALUE
In U · Understand, add contract hours, unpaid overtime and commute. That's what one hour of your life is worth.

08
GIVE RECLAIMED MONEY A JOB
Set up a standing transfer for your reclaimed amount on payday, before it can disappear.

HEAVY-WEEK VERSION
Skip the full list. Write down only your five biggest costs and cancel one subscription you forgot you had.

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO
T · Track, R · Reclaim, U · Understand. Done when the KEEP dashboard shows your keep rate.

✓ 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN
✓ Search your banking app for the word “subscription” or “abo” and cancel the first one you don't use.

STAGE 2 · DEEP DIVE

WORKED EXAMPLE

Your first money snapshot

What a finished Stage 2 looks like

Here is a real-looking example from TRUST Tracker Pro, so you know exactly what you're aiming for. Replace these numbers with your own and the picture becomes yours.

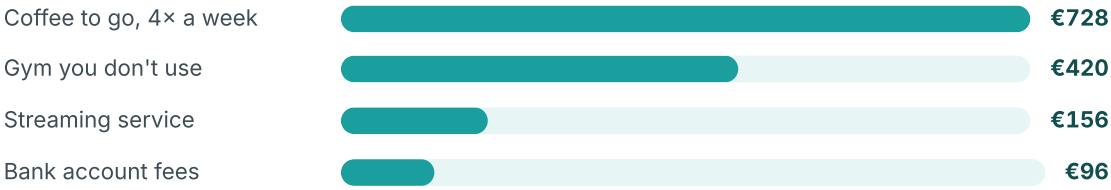
EXAMPLE MONTH · €2,560 NET IN



Needs €1,740 · Wants €265 · Keep €555

Your keep rate is what you keep divided by what comes in. A rough guide: below 0% means urgent action, 0–10% is a start, 10–20% is solid, above 20% is strong. Every percentage point counts.

SMALL LEAKS, YEARLY COST



€3.50 coffee × 4 × 52 weeks; €35 gym; €12.99 streaming; €8 fees. Together €1,400 a year: almost a full starter buffer for many people.

SCRIPT · THE ONE CALL

"Hi, I've been a customer for [X] years. I've seen your current offer for new customers is € [Y]. I'd like to stay, but I'd need a better price. What can you offer me today?" Then stay quiet and let them answer.

READ YOUR PAYSLIP ONCE

1. Gross pay: what your contract says
2. Tax and social contributions: what leaves before you see it
3. Pension or employer benefits: part of your pay, not a cost
4. Net pay: the number your plan is built on

0:00–0:20
Gather
Payslip, 3 months of statements, debt letters.

0:20–1:00
Enter
Money in, then every cost, in T · Track.

1:00–1:30
Sort
Need or want, one line at a time. No judging.

1:30–1:50
Reclaim
Subscriptions and contracts into R · Reclaim.

1:50–2:00
Automate
One standing order on payday. Done.

Your 2-hour setup session, minute by minute. Stop at any line and continue next week: the tracker keeps your place.

STAGE 2 · YOUR SALARY

FROM WEEK 2, ONGOING

RUNS ALONGSIDE EVERY STAGE

Grow the number at the top

Pillar 1 · Career & cybersecurity

For most professionals, their job is the most powerful wealth engine they will ever own. A €300 monthly raise asks for no extra hours each week, yet it pays more than most side hustles earn in their first year. Protect it and grow it first.

01

KNOW YOUR MARKET VALUE

Check salary reports and job ads for your role and city. Write down a realistic range, not a dream number.

02

KEEP A WIN FILE

One note, updated every Friday: results, numbers, praise, problems you solved. It writes your review for you.

03

BOOK THE CONVERSATION

Ask for your salary review 6–8 weeks before budgets are set, not on the day itself.

04

ASK FOR MORE THAN MONEY

Flexible hours, remote days, training budget, a certification paid for. For carers, flexibility can be worth more than cash.

05

PICK ONE SKILL WITH LEVERAGE

One course or certification a year that your market pays for. In cybersecurity: cloud security, governance, an entry certification.

06

MAKE YOURSELF VISIBLE

One LinkedIn post a month about what you learned. Recruiters and future clients find you without you job hunting.

07

BUILD A QUIET SAFETY PLAN

An updated CV and five people you could call. Career security is part of financial security.

08

LOG EVERY RAISE

Add it to Income Streams as “Career”. Then decide where it goes: buffer, debt or investing, before lifestyle grabs it.

HEAVY-WEEK VERSION

Add one line to your win file. That's it. Five minutes on a Friday builds a strong case over a year.

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

Income Streams (type: Career). Update your net salary on T · Track when the raise lands.

✔ 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

✔ Start your win file now. Write down three things you did well in the last three months, with a number for each.

STAGE 2 · YOUR TOOL SCRIPTS & TEMPLATES

Your win file & salary conversation

Prepare once, use every year

A raise is rarely given for working hard. It is given for results someone can see and repeat. These templates turn your everyday work into evidence, and your evidence into a calm, clear conversation.

WIN FILE TEMPLATE · EVERY FRIDAY

1. What I delivered this week
2. The number behind it (time, money, risk reduced)
3. Who benefited
4. Praise or feedback I received
5. What I learned

SALARY CONVERSATION · STRUCTURE

1. Open with your results, not your needs
2. Show three wins with numbers
3. Name your market range
4. Ask clearly: "I'd like to move to €X."
5. If budget is tight, ask for flexibility, training or a date to revisit

RAISE PREP SHEET · FILL IN BEFORE YOU BOOK THE MEETING

1. My market range for this role and city: €_____ to €_____
2. My three strongest wins this year, each with a number: _____ · _____ · _____
3. What I'll ask for: €_____, or instead: remote days / training / certification / fewer hours
4. The date I'll ask (6–8 weeks before budgets are set): _____
5. Where the raise goes the day it lands: _____% buffer or debt · _____% investing · _____% time

IF THEY SAY "NOT NOW"

Ask: "What would I need to show by when, for this to be a yes?" Write it down and agree a date.

Ask for what costs them less: a training budget, a title, flexible hours or one remote day.

Add the answer to your win file. Next year's conversation starts today.

WINS THAT COUNT · WITH NUMBERS

1. "Automated a report: saves the team 6 hours a month"
2. "Closed 14 audit findings before the deadline"
3. "Trained 3 new colleagues, all productive in 4 weeks"
4. "Reduced vendor costs by €8,000 a year"

WINS THAT DON'T COUNT YET

1. "Worked late a lot": effort, not a result
2. "Was very busy": add what came out of it
3. "Helped the team": who, how, what changed?
4. Turn each into a number before you use it

STAGE 2 · CHECKLIST DONE WHEN



Know your salary & your numbers · done when

Tick every box before you move on. Slow is fine. Skipping is what costs money.

Each box is something you can see, not something you feel. When all of them are ticked, write today's date here: _____.

- [ ] Every euro in and out for one normal month is in T · Track.
- [ ] I know my baseline (needs) and my keep rate.
- [ ] I cancelled or renegotiated at least one cost in R · Reclaim.
- [ ] Reclaimed money moves on payday by standing order.
- [ ] My win file has its first three wins with numbers.
- [ ] I know my market range and the date I'll ask for my review.

WRITE IT DOWN

1. My keep rate today: _____%. My goal in 6 months: _____%
2. The leak I cut and what it saves a year...
3. My review date and my ask...

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

T · Track shows your keep rate, R · Reclaim your reclaimable euros, Income Streams logs any raise as "Career". The KEEP dashboard should now show Level 1 or higher.

NEXT STAGE UNLOCKS WHEN

What you keep is €0 or more every month (Level 1 · Stable).

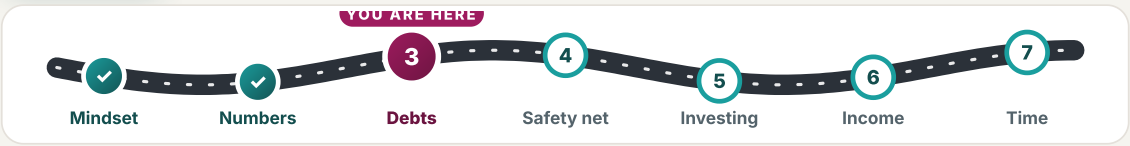
COMMON MISTAKES AT THIS STAGE

- Guessing numbers instead of checking statements
- Cutting everything at once, then giving up
- Treating a raise as permission to spend

LILIANE'S TIP

- Use real statements. Your memory is kinder than your bank.
- Cut one leak at a time, and move it on payday.
- Give the raise a job before it arrives.

STAGE 3 | MONTHS 2–5 | GOAL: LEVEL 2 → 3 | OPTIONAL



Clear your debts

Pillar 2 · TRUST: Understand & Save

This stage is optional: if you have no consumer debt, save your starter buffer and go straight to Stage 4. If you do, your money can still grow while you pay it off, just more slowly. Expensive debt is a leak that works against you every single day, so stopping it is the fastest "return" you'll ever earn.

01
SAVE A STARTER BUFFER FIRST
One month of needs in a separate account. Without it, the first broken washing machine goes straight back on the card.

02
LIST EVERY DEBT
In U · Understand: balance, interest rate, minimum payment. The tracker shows what each one costs you a month.

03
PAY EVERY MINIMUM, ALWAYS
Missed payments add fees and damage your credit. Automate the minimums on payday.

04
ATTACK PRIORITY 1
Every extra euro goes to the highest interest rate. The tracker ranks your debts for you.

05
STOP NEW DEBT
Remove saved cards from shopping sites. Turn off buy-now-pay-later. Your buffer is for emergencies now.

06
CALL YOUR LENDER
Ask for a lower rate or a payment plan. The script on page 24 helps. One call can save hundreds.

07
ROLL PAYMENTS FORWARD
When one debt is gone, its whole payment moves to the next. Don't let it fade back into spending.

08
CELEBRATE LEVEL 3
Debt-free is a huge milestone. Mark the date. Do something small and free with someone you love.

HEAVY-WEEK VERSION
Keep the automatic minimums and your extra payment running. Do nothing else. Automation keeps going when you can't.

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO
U · Understand ranks your debts, shows months to clear and the interest you pay a year. S · Save tracks your starter buffer.

✔ 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN
✔ Look at "Interest you pay / year" on the KEEP dashboard. Write that number on a sticky note. That's what this stage wins back.

STAGE 3 · DEEP DIVE

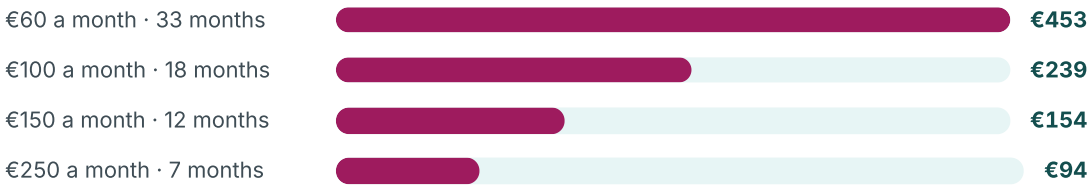
DEBT MATHS

The maths that sets you free

Why a little more each month changes everything

Interest is the price of borrowed time. The faster you repay, the less you pay. A small increase in your monthly payment makes a dramatic difference.

€1,500 CREDIT CARD AT 19.9% · TOTAL INTEREST PAID



Raising the payment from €60 to €100 saves €214 and clears the debt 15 months sooner. Calculated with monthly interest and fixed payments.

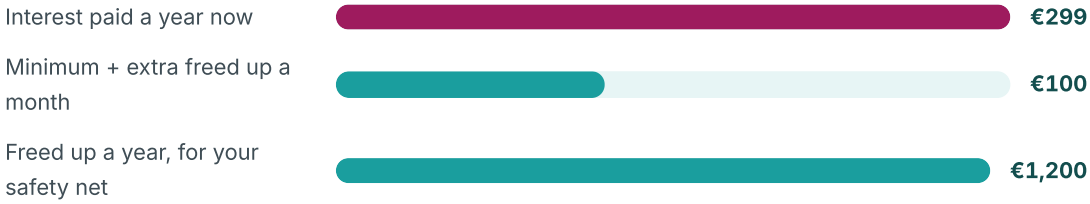
AVALANCHE (USED IN YOUR TRACKER)

Extra money goes to the highest interest rate first. Mathematically the cheapest route.

SNOWBALL

Extra money goes to the smallest balance first. Costs a little more, but quick wins keep some people motivated. Both work if you stick with them.

WHAT ONE DEBT-FREE YEAR GIVES BACK · EXAMPLE



Credit card €1,500 at 19.9%, from the tracker example. Once it's gone, the €100 a month you paid moves straight to Stage 4.

WHERE THE EXTRA €40 A MONTH CAN COME FROM

1. One cancelled subscription from R · Reclaim
2. Cooking twice more a week instead of takeaway
3. Selling one thing you no longer use
4. Your next raise, before you get used to it

KEEP THE DEBT FROM COMING BACK

1. Card removed from shopping sites and apps
2. Buy-now-pay-later switched off
3. Starter buffer for real surprises
4. Goal pots for the costs you know are coming

STAGE 3 · DEEP DIVE KNOW YOUR DEBT

Not all debt is the same

Which debt to clear first, and which can wait

In my 20s I took out loans for my study fees and made financial decisions I'd make very differently today. Paying off €30,000 taught me one thing above all: the interest rate decides the order, not the size of the balance or how guilty a debt makes you feel.

TYPE OF DEBT	TYPICAL COST	WHAT TO DO
Overdraft	Often 10–15%+ a year	Priority. Clear it first and keep a buffer so you don't slide back.
Credit card balance	Often 15–20%+ a year	Priority. Pay more than the minimum, highest rate first.
Buy now, pay later	0% until a payment is missed	Stop new ones. Late fees and stacking several make it expensive.
Car or consumer loan	Mid-range	Pay as agreed. Extra payments once cards are gone, if no early-repayment fee.
Student loan	Often low, sometimes tied to income	Pay as agreed. Rarely worth rushing before your safety net.
Mortgage	Usually the lowest	Not part of this stage. Pay as agreed.

Rates differ by country, lender and contract. Check the effective yearly rate on your own statements.

WHY THIS STAGE IS OPTIONAL

If your only debt is a low-rate student loan or a mortgage, you don't need to clear it before you move on. Save your starter buffer and go to Stage 4. Paying off expensive debt is the priority. Cheap debt can be paid as agreed while your money grows elsewhere.

NO SHAME, ONLY A PLAN

Debt is a number, not a judgement of who you are. Most people with debt got there through study, illness, caring for someone, or simply not being taught. You were never meant to figure this out alone.

⚑ ASK FOR HELP EARLY IF...

- ⚑ You can't pay the minimums for two months in a row.
- ⚑ You're using one card to pay another.
- ⚑ Collection letters are arriving. Free, regulated debt advice exists in most countries (in Germany: Schuldnerberatung).

STAGE 3 · YOUR TOOL WORKSHEET & SCRIPT

Your debt payoff plan

One page that shows the way out

Write your debts down in order of interest rate. Seeing the finish line is half the work. Copy these numbers into U · Understand and the tracker will estimate how many months each one takes.

PRIORITY	DEBT	BALANCE €	INTEREST %	MINIMUM €	EXTRA €	PAID OFF BY
1						
2						
3						
4						

SCRIPT · CALL YOUR LENDER

"Hi, I've been a customer for [X] years and I'm working on paying off my balance faster. Is there a lower interest rate or a repayment plan you can offer me? Other banks offer [Y]%. What can you do for me today?" Write down the name of the person and what they offered.

WHEN A DEBT IS GONE

1. Close the card or lower the limit
2. Move its whole payment to the next debt the same day
3. Write the date on this page
4. Tell someone. It's a real win

YOUR MONTHLY DEBT CHECK · 5 MINUTES

1. All minimums paid automatically?
2. Extra payment went to Priority 1?
3. New balance written in U · Understand
4. Any new debt? If yes, why, and the fix

FIND EXTRA FOR PRIORITY 1

1. Reclaimed money from Stage 2
2. Tax refund or bonus: at least half
3. Side income, after its tax pot
4. Rounding up every payment to the next €10

IF YOU'RE TEMPTED TO USE THE CARD AGAIN

Wait 48 hours. Most urges are gone by then.

Check your goal pots first. If it's a known cost, it should have a pot.

Use the starter buffer for real emergencies only, and refill it before any extra payment.

MY DEBT-FREE DATE

Total debt €_____ ÷ **(minimums + extra a month)** €_____ = about _____ months

Add a few months for interest. U · Understand calculates it exactly, debt by debt. My debt-free month:

_____

STAGE 3 · CHECKLIST

DONE WHEN



Clear your debts · done when

Tick every box before you move on. Slow is fine. Skipping is what costs money.

Each box is something you can see, not something you feel. When all of them are ticked, write today's date here: _____.

- [ ] My starter buffer of one month of needs is saved in a separate account.
- [ ] Every debt is listed with its rate, and I know my Priority 1.
- [ ] All minimums run automatically on payday.
- [ ] I have no new consumer debt and buy-now-pay-later is switched off.
- [ ] I called at least one lender or provider.
- [ ] Consumer debt (cards, overdraft, BNPL) is €0, or I skipped this stage because I had none.

WRITE IT DOWN

1. The date I became debt-free...
2. What my old debt payment pays for now...
3. How I'll celebrate, for free...

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

U · Understand: total debt and interest per year at €0. S · Save: starter buffer done. The KEEP dashboard shows Level 3 · Debt-free.

NEXT STAGE UNLOCKS WHEN

Consumer debt is gone (Level 3), or you had none and your starter buffer is full.

COMMON MISTAKES AT THIS STAGE

- Paying off debt with no buffer, then borrowing again
- Splitting extra money across every debt
- Closing old cards before the balances are paid

LILIANE'S TIP

- Starter buffer first, always.
- All extra goes to Priority 1: the highest rate.
- Pay first, then close or lower the limit.

STAGE 4 | MONTHS 3–9 | GOAL: LEVEL 4



Build a safety net

Pillar 2 · TRUST: Save

When others rely on you, a surprise bill doesn't only cost money. It costs sleep. A full emergency fund turns a job loss, a care emergency or a broken car from a crisis into a problem you can handle.

01
CHOOSE YOUR NUMBER OF MONTHS
3 months of needs, or 6 if you're a carer, the only earner or self-employed. Set it in S · Save.

02
KEEP IT SEPARATE
A savings account that is easy to reach in a day or two, but not linked to your everyday card.

03
AUTOMATE THE TRANSFER
A fixed amount on payday, before anything else. Your old debt payment is perfect for this.

04
CREATE GOAL POTS
Christmas, birthdays, car repairs, care costs: predictable “surprises” get their own monthly amount.

05
WRITE YOUR EMERGENCY RULE
Decide now what counts as an emergency, so you don't have to decide in a hard moment.

06
CHECK YOUR INSURANCE
Liability, health and, if people depend on you, income protection or life cover. The cheapest safety net is often a policy.

07
REFILL BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE
If you use the fund, refilling it comes before investing or extra spending.

08
MARK LEVEL 4
A full fund is real security. Note the date: from here, your money can start working for you.

HEAVY-WEEK VERSION
Leave the automatic transfer running. Even €25 a month keeps the habit alive.

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO
S · Save shows your target, progress and months to go. The KEEP dashboard turns to Level 4 · Secure when the fund is full.

✓ 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN
✓ Rename your savings account to “Safety net – do not touch”. A name changes how you treat money.

STAGE 4 · DEEP DIVE HOW BIG?

How big should your safety net be?

Enough to sleep well, not so much that it stops your money growing

Your emergency fund is insurance, not an investment. It should be boring, separate and easy to reach. Here's how to size it for your life, and how long it takes.

YOUR SITUATION	MONTHS OF NEEDS	EXAMPLE AT €1,740 NEEDS
Stable job, no one depends on you	3 months	€5,220
Carer, parent or single earner	6 months	€10,440
Self-employed or irregular income	6 months or more	€10,440+

3-MONTH EMERGENCY FUND (€5,220) · €1,200 ALREADY SAVED · MONTHS TO GO



Adding the €100 freed up from debt in Stage 3 turns €150 into €250 a month, and saves 10 months.

IT IS AN EMERGENCY IF...

1. You lose income
2. Health or care needs you didn't plan for
3. A repair you need to work or live safely

IT IS NOT AN EMERGENCY IF...

1. It happens every year (that's a goal pot)
2. It's on sale
3. It can wait 30 days

WHERE TO KEEP IT	GOOD FOR A SAFETY NET?	WHY
Current account	No	Too easy to spend by accident, often no interest.
Separate savings or instant-access account	Yes	Easy to reach in a day or two, kept apart from daily spending.
Fixed-term deposit	Only part of it	Better rate, but locked. Keep at least one month instantly available.
Shares or funds	No	Can be down exactly when you need them. That's Stage 5 money.

IF YOU'RE STARTING FROM ZERO

Aim for €500 first. It covers most small emergencies and builds the habit.

Then one month of needs (your starter buffer), then the full fund.

Any amount counts. €25 a month is a habit; the amount can grow later.

STAGE 4 · DEEP DIVE AUTOMATION

Your automated payday

Set it up once, and let it run while you live your life

Willpower runs out at the end of a long day. Automation doesn't. When your transfers happen on payday, before you can spend, saving stops being a decision you have to make every month.

YOUR AUTOMATED PAYDAY · SET IT UP ONCE

Salary arrives

Day 1 · Bills account
needs, rent, contracts

Day 1 · Keep your first hour
buffer → emergency fund

Day 1 · Debt extra
Priority 1 debt

Day 2 · Goal pots
gifts, care, holiday

Later · Investing
only from Level 4

What's left is guilt-free spending

YOUR IF-THEN RULES · WRITE THEM DOWN

If it's payday, **then** the transfers run before I spend anything.

If I want to buy something over €50, **then** I wait 48 hours.

If I get a raise or bonus, **then** half goes to my future before I adjust my lifestyle.

If I've had a heavy week, **then** I do the 2-minute check and nothing more.

GOAL POTS · PREDICTABLE "SURPRISES"



From the S · Save example. When the bill arrives, the money is already there.

STAGE 4 · YOUR TOOL CALCULATOR

Your emergency buffer calculator

Five lines, one number, one date

Fill this in with the numbers from T · Track and S · Save. When you're done, you know exactly how big your safety net needs to be and the month it will be full.

FILL IN

1 · My monthly needs (baseline) €_____

From T · Track: rent, bills, food, transport, care, debt minimums

2 · Months of safety I want _____

3, or 6 if you're a carer, the only earner or self-employed

3 · My target = line 1 × line 2 = €_____

4 · Saved so far €_____ **5 · Monthly transfer** €_____

Months to go = (line 3 − line 4) ÷ line 5 = _____

My safety net is full in: _____ (month and year)

YOUR SAFETY-NET RULES

If I use the fund, **then** refilling it comes before investing or anything new.

If I get a bonus or tax refund, **then** half goes to the fund until it's full.

If something is an annual cost, **then** it gets a goal pot, not the emergency fund.

WHERE I KEEP IT

Bank: _____ · Account name: _____ · Linked to my everyday card: **no**

COLOUR IN ONE BOX FOR EVERY 2% OF YOUR TARGET

The pink boxes are your milestones: halfway, and the full fund. Stick this page on the fridge.

FIVE WAYS TO FILL IT FASTER

1. Half of every bonus or tax refund
2. Your old debt payment, from Stage 3
3. Reclaimed costs from R · Reclaim
4. Selling what you no longer use
5. 1–2% of every raise

MILESTONES TO CELEBRATE, FOR FREE

1. €500: small emergencies are covered
2. One month of needs: starter buffer done
3. 50%: a walk somewhere you love
4. 100%: Level 4 · Secure. Write down the date
5. Tell someone. It matters.

STAGE 4 · CHECKLIST DONE WHEN



Build a safety net · done when

Tick every box before you move on. Slow is fine. Skipping is what costs money.

Each box is something you can see, not something you feel. When all of them are ticked, write today's date here: _____.

- [ ] I chose 3 or 6 months and know my target in euros.
- [ ] My fund is in a separate account, not linked to my card.
- [ ] A fixed transfer runs on payday.
- [ ] My predictable costs have their own goal pots.
- [ ] I wrote down what counts as an emergency.
- [ ] My full emergency fund is 100% saved.

WRITE IT DOWN

1. The month my fund was full...
2. My emergency rule in one sentence...
3. What feels different now...

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

S · Save: progress at 100% and "Done ✓". The KEEP dashboard shows Level 4 · Secure, and the Invest tab says the first check is "Yes ✓".

NEXT STAGE UNLOCKS WHEN

Your full fund is in place (Level 4 · Secure). Now your money can start working for you.

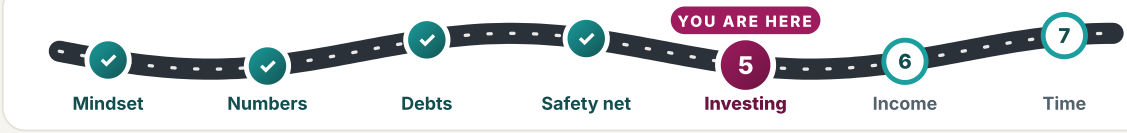
COMMON MISTAKES AT THIS STAGE

- Keeping the fund in your current account
- Using it for holidays and Christmas
- Investing before it's full

LILIANE'S TIP

- Separate account, with a name that reminds you why.
- Known costs get goal pots, not the fund.
- Full fund first. Then Stage 5.

STAGE 5 · MONTHS 8–12 · MONEY THAT WORKS FOR YOU



Build wealth with smart investing

Pillar 3 · Wealth building & investing education

Your safety net is full. Now you can learn how long-term investing really works. This page teaches principles; it doesn't recommend any product, fund or provider.

01
CONFIRM YOUR SAFETY NET
Full emergency fund and no consumer debt. The Invest tab checks both for you.

02
CHECK WHAT YOUR EMPLOYER OFFERS
Workplace pension schemes and employer contributions are part of your pay. Find out what you're entitled to.

03
ONLY INVEST IN WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND
Learn diversification, time horizon, compound growth, inflation, risk and volatility first. If you can't explain an investment in two sentences, don't buy it.

04
KNOW YOUR TIME HORIZON
Money you need within 5 years doesn't belong in the stock market. Long-term investing is for long-term money.

05
WATCH THE COSTS
Fees look tiny and compound massively. Always ask: what do I pay per year, in total, in percent?

06
CHOOSE A RISK YOU CAN SLEEP WITH
Could you watch your investment fall 30% and not sell? If not, take less risk. Your nerves are part of the plan.

07
AUTOMATE, THEN LEAVE IT
A fixed monthly amount, on payday, reviewed once a year. Checking daily helps nobody.

08
CHECK WHO YOU'RE DEALING WITH
Use only regulated providers and advisers (in Germany, check the BaFin register). Guaranteed high returns are a red flag. In my 20s I was heavily into trading without knowing much about it, and I fell for an online scam. Please take this one seriously.

HEAVY-WEEK VERSION

Read one page or watch one video on a single concept from step 3. Learning counts as progress.

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

Invest: the readiness check, what time and fees could do, and what you already invest each month.

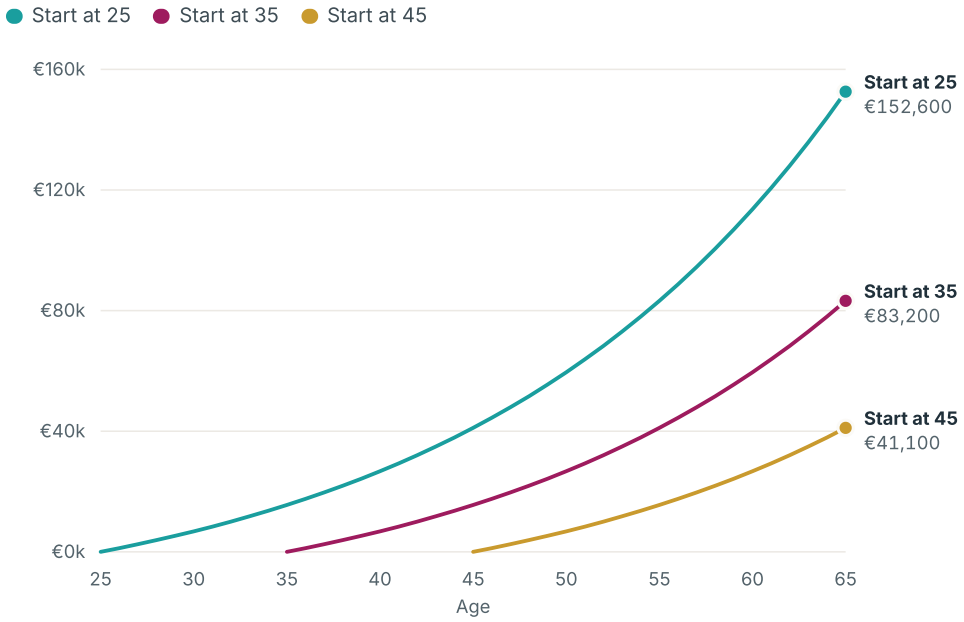
STAGE 5 · DEEP DIVE COMPOUND GROWTH

Time is the strongest ingredient

What I wish someone had shown me in my 20s

Compound growth means your returns begin earning returns of their own. In the early years, it can feel as if nothing is happening. Then the curve bends upwards, and most of the growth arrives in the final decades. That's why **when** you start matters more than **how much** you start with.

€100 A MONTH, 5% A YEAR, VALUE AT EACH AGE UNTIL 65



YOU START AT	YEARS INVESTING	YOU PAY IN	VALUE AT 65	GROWTH ON TOP
25	40	€48,000	€152,600	€104,600
35	30	€36,000	€83,200	€47,200
45	20	€24,000	€41,100	€17,100

THE 10-YEAR HEAD START

Starting at 25 instead of 35 adds about **€69,400** at 65, for only €12,000 more paid in. Those first ten years of €100 a month do almost as much as the next thirty.

ALREADY PAST 25?

So am I. The best time to start was earlier. The second best is now. Starting at 35 still more than doubles what you pay in. Don't let regret cost you another ten years.

Illustration only, not a forecast or a recommendation. Assumes a fixed 5% a year, compounded monthly, no fees, taxes or inflation. Real returns go up and down, aren't guaranteed, and you can lose money. Only invest money you won't need for many years, after your emergency fund is in place.

STAGE 5 · DEEP DIVE START NOW

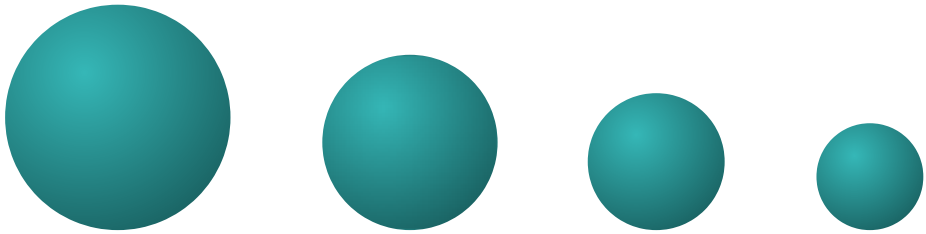
Every day you wait has a price

Time you don't invest is time you can't get back

The best time to plant a tree was twenty years ago. The second best time is today. Money works the same way: a euro planted early has decades to grow its roots, while a euro planted late never catches up. The same is true for financial knowledge. Every day you learn, your next decision gets better.

€23.55 That's roughly what every single day of waiting costs a 25-year-old who puts off a €100 monthly plan by one year, measured in value at 65 (5% a year). One year of "I'll start next month" costs about **€8,600**.

THE SAME €1,200 SAVED IN ONE YEAR · WHAT IT GROWS TO BY 65



€8,596	€5,219	€3,169	€1,924
saved at 25	saved at 35	saved at 45	saved at 55

Each circle's area shows the value at 65 of one year of €100 a month, invested at a hypothetical 5% a year. The seed you plant at 25 grows into a tree more than four times larger than the one planted at 55.

THE COST OF WAITING · STARTING AT 25 WITH €100 A MONTH



Value lost at 65 compared with starting at 25. Illustration only, fixed 5% a year, before fees, taxes and inflation. Returns aren't guaranteed.

WHY YOUR BRAIN SAYS "LATER"

Economists call it **present bias**: we give far more weight to comfort today than to rewards in the future, so "next month" always feels reasonable. Knowing this is your advantage. Don't wait to feel ready. Decide once, then automate it.

Laibson (1997); O'Donoghue & Rabin (1999)

DECIDE IN 5 SECONDS

The "5 Second Rule", popularised by Mel Robbins, says: when you know what to do, count 5-4-3-2-1 and move before your mind talks you out of it. It's a self-help technique rather than a scientific finding, but it's a useful nudge. Count down, open your banking app, set up the transfer.

STAGE 5 · DEEP DIVE

PROTECT YOUR MONEY

Inflation, risk and red flags

Why cash alone isn't enough, and how to avoid what happened to me

Money in a current account feels safe, but inflation slowly eats its value. At the same time, the wrong investment can cost far more. This page helps you avoid both mistakes.

WHAT €10,000 IN CASH CAN BUY OVER TIME



Purchasing power, in today's euros. Your emergency fund belongs in cash; long-term money needs a plan to keep up with inflation.

YEARLY GROWTH	YEARS FOR MONEY TO DOUBLE
2%	about 35 years
4%	about 18 years
6%	about 12 years
8%	about 9 years

The rule of 72: divide 72 by the yearly growth rate to estimate how long it takes to double. It works the same way for debt.

11.4% vs 17.9%

Between 1991 and 1996, the households that traded most earned 11.4% a year, while the market returned 17.9%. Trading more usually means earning less.

Barber & Odean, Journal of Finance (2000)

$4.6bn

Investment scams were the costliest fraud category reported to the US Federal Trade Commission in 2023, out of about $10 billion in total reported losses.

US Federal Trade Commission, Consumer Sentinel data (2024)

⚑ SCAM RED FLAGS · FROM MY OWN EXPERIENCE

- ⚑ Guaranteed or unusually high returns, often “risk-free”.
- ⚑ Pressure to decide fast, or a contact who found *you* on social media.
- ⚑ A platform you can't find in your regulator's register (in Germany: BaFin).
- ⚑ You're asked to pay a “fee” or “tax” before you can withdraw your own money.
- ⚑ You can't explain the investment to a friend in two sentences.

STAGE 5 · YOUR TOOL BEFORE YOU BUY

Only invest in what you understand

The two-sentence test and the words you need

In my 20s I traded without really understanding what I was doing, and I paid for it. Today I use one simple rule: if I can't explain an investment to a friend in two sentences, I don't buy it. These are the words you need to pass that test.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS, IN PLAIN LANGUAGE
Diversification	Spreading money across many companies and countries, so one failure can't sink you.
Index fund	A fund that follows a whole market instead of picking winners. Usually low cost.
Costs (TER)	What you pay every year, in percent. Small numbers, huge effect over decades.
Time horizon	How long until you need the money. Under 5 years: not for the stock market.
Volatility	How much the value goes up and down. Normal, and why you need a long horizon.
Risk you can sleep with	The drop you could watch without selling. Your nerves are part of the plan.

THE TWO-SENTENCE TEST · FILL IN BEFORE YOU BUY

1 · What it is: _____

2 · How it makes money, and how it could lose money: _____

Costs a year: _____% · **Regulated provider:** yes / no · **I need this money in:** _____ years

This page explains concepts. It doesn't recommend any product, fund or provider. For your own situation, speak to a regulated, independent adviser.

ASK ANY PROVIDER BEFORE YOU SIGN

1. Who regulates you, and where can I check that?
2. What does it cost a year, all in, in percent?
3. How do I get my money out, and how long does it take?
4. What happens to my money if you go bankrupt?

WALK AWAY IF...

1. They promise high returns with little risk
2. They push you to decide today
3. You can't find them in the official register
4. They contacted you first, on social media

In Germany you can check providers in the BaFin company database. Other countries have their own regulator registers.

STAGE 5 · CHECKLIST DONE WHEN



Build wealth with smart investing · done when

Tick every box before you move on. Slow is fine. Skipping is what costs money.

Each box is something you can see, not something you feel. When all of them are ticked, write today's date here: _____.

- [ ] The Invest tab readiness check shows “Ready ✓”.
- [ ] I checked what my employer offers (pension, contributions).
- [ ] I can explain what I invest in, in two sentences.
- [ ] I know the yearly costs, in percent, of everything I hold.
- [ ] A fixed monthly amount runs on payday.
- [ ] I only use regulated providers, and I know the scam red flags.

WRITE IT DOWN

1. What I invest in, in two sentences...
2. My monthly amount and the date I review it each year...
3. The red flag I'll never ignore...

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

Invest: readiness check, monthly amount and value so far. The KEEP dashboard shows “Invested / month”.

NEXT STAGE UNLOCKS WHEN

Your investing runs on its own, and you understand what you own. Then you're ready to add a second income.

COMMON MISTAKES AT THIS STAGE

- Buying what a friend or influencer recommends
- Checking your investments every day
- Stopping your monthly amount when markets fall

LILIANE'S TIP

- If you can't explain it in two sentences, don't buy it.
- Look once a year, on your money date.
- Falling prices mean you buy more for the same money.

STAGE 6 | MONTHS 6–12 | GOAL: LEVEL 5



Build multiple income streams

Pillar 4 · Multiple income streams

Not five streams at once. One stream, tested for 90 days, in the two to four hours a week you can genuinely protect. Choose what fits your time and energy, not what happens to be trending.

STREAM	TIME TO FIRST €	HOURS IT NEEDS	GROWS WITHOUT YOU	GOOD FIT IF YOU...
Freelance / consulting	●●●	●●●	●○○	have a skill people already pay your employer for
UGC	●●○	●●○	●○○	can film short videos in small pockets of time
Digital products	●○○	●●○	●●●	solve one problem well and can write it down
YouTube / content	●○○	●●●	●●●	enjoy teaching and can be patient for a year
Brand deals & affiliate	●○○	●○○	●●○	already have an engaged audience, even a small one

●●● = fast / a lot / strongly. Rough guide only; your results depend on your skills, niche and time.

01
CHECK THE RULES FIRST
Read your employment contract on side work and conflicts of interest. Check how to register and pay tax on side income where you live.

02
PICK ONE STREAM
Use the table. Choose what you could start this month with the skills and hours you have now.

03
PROTECT TWO BLOCKS
Two fixed slots of 1–2 hours a week. Take them from scrolling or TV, never from sleep or family first.

04
RUN A 90-DAY TEST
One clear offer, shown to real people. Measure euros, not likes. Decide at day 90: keep, change or stop.

05
TRACK € PER HOUR
Income Streams calculates it. Under your job's hourly value? Make sure it's buying you something: skills, an asset or future freedom.

06
GIVE SIDE INCOME A JOB
Decide the split up front, for example: part for tax, part to investing, part to your time goal.

HEAVY-WEEK VERSION

Cancel the block, don't feel guilty, and write down one idea for next week. Paused isn't failed.

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

Income Streams: status, hours, € per hour, share of needs covered. Level 5 lights up at 25%.

STAGE 6 · DEEP DIVE 90-DAY TEST

Your 90-day income stream test

A clear plan, week by week

Most side projects fail because they never get a clear test. This plan gives your idea 13 weeks and three hours a week, then asks one honest question: keep, change or stop?

WEEKS 1–2

Define one offer

Who it helps, the problem it solves, the price. One sentence each.

WEEKS 3–6

Show up

Share it where your people are. Two posts or ten conversations a week.

WEEKS 7–10

Ask for the sale

Make a clear offer to real people. Collect yeses, nos and feedback.

WEEKS 11–13

Measure & decide

Log euros and hours in Income Streams. Compare € per hour with your job.

€ PER HOUR · COMPARE BEFORE YOU DECIDE (EXAMPLE)



Job and digital product values come from the TRUST Tracker Pro example; the freelance rate is illustrative. Early digital products often pay little per hour, but they can keep selling later.

KEEP IT IF...

1. You earned your first euros
2. People asked for more
3. You'd happily do another 90 days

CHANGE OR STOP IF...

1. No one bought after a clear offer
2. It drains the energy you need at home
3. It pays less per hour and builds nothing for later

YOUR 3 PROTECTED HOURS A WEEK

1. Block 1 · 90 minutes: create (write, build, record)
2. Block 2 · 90 minutes: show up (share, talk, sell)
3. Same two slots every week, in your calendar
4. Never taken from sleep or family time first

WHAT TO LOG EVERY FRIDAY

1. Hours spent this week
2. People reached or conversations had
3. Euros earned, if any
4. One thing you learned about your buyers

PROTECT THE TEST

No new ideas until day 90. Write them on a "later" list instead.

Heavy week? Do one 30-minute block. The test pauses, it doesn't fail.

Tell one person your day-90 date. It makes stopping or keeping a real decision.

STAGE 6 · DEEP DIVE YOUR OFFER

One offer on one page

Clear beats clever, and one beats five

Most side income fails before the first sale, because the offer is vague. Before you build anything, write it down on one page. If you can't fill it in, you're not ready to sell yet, and that's useful to know.

YOUR ONE-PAGE OFFER

Who it's for: _____
One kind of person, not “everyone”

The problem it solves: _____
In their words, not yours

What they get: _____
A result, not a list of features

Price: €_____
Start simple. You can raise it after the first 10 buyers

Where they'll find it: _____
One channel where they already are

RULES FIRST

1. Check your employment contract on side work and conflicts of interest
2. Find out how to register and pay tax on side income where you live
3. Keep 30% of side income aside for tax until you know your real rate

€ PER HOUR, HONESTLY

If a stream pays less per hour than your job, it must buy you something else: a skill, an asset that keeps selling, or a path to more time later. If it buys nothing, stop it without guilt.

EXAMPLE · FILLED IN

Who it's for: women moving into cybersecurity from another career

The problem: “I don't know where to start, and I'm scared I'm too late.”

What they get: a 30-day starter plan, with the first certification and a CV template

Price: €29 · **Where they'll find it:** Instagram, where I already share my story

PRICE CHECK

Too cheap if you'd be annoyed to sell it 50 times.

About right if the first 10 buyers say yes without a long discussion.

Raise it after 10 happy buyers, not before the first.

STAGE 6 · YOUR TOOL

TRACKER SHEET

Your 90-day test, week by week

Print it, stick it on the fridge, fill in one row a week

Euros, not likes. Write down what you did and what came back. At week 13, the numbers make the keep, change or stop decision for you.

WEEK	HOURS	WHAT I DID	PEOPLE REACHED	€ EARNED
Week 1				
Week 2				
Week 3				
Week 4				
Week 5				
Week 6				
Week 7				
Week 8				
Week 9				
Week 10				
Week 11				
Week 12				
Week 13				

DAY 90

Total € _____ ÷ total hours _____ = € per hour _____

Compare with your real hourly value from Stage 1

My decision: keep · change · stop

Log it in Income Streams

DAY-90 DECISION RULES

Keep if € per hour is rising and you enjoy it, even if it's still below your job.

Change if people are interested but not buying: fix the offer, the price or the channel.

Stop if nobody bites after 90 days of real effort. That's data, not failure.

STAGE 6 · CHECKLIST

DONE WHEN



Build multiple income streams · done when

Tick every box before you move on. Slow is fine. Skipping is what costs money.

Each box is something you can see, not something you feel. When all of them are ticked, write today's date here: _____.

- [ ] I checked my contract and the tax rules for side income.
- [ ] I picked one stream that fits my skills and hours.
- [ ] Two weekly blocks are protected, not taken from sleep or family.
- [ ] My one-page offer is written.
- [ ] I finished a 90-day test and made a keep, change or stop decision.
- [ ] Side income has a plan: tax, investing and time.

WRITE IT DOWN

1. My stream and my decision at day 90...
2. My € per hour vs my job...
3. The next small step...

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

Income Streams: status, hours, € per hour and the share of your needs covered. Level 5 · Flexible lights up at 25%.

NEXT STAGE UNLOCKS WHEN

One stream has a clear result, and extra income covers part of your needs (Level 5 · Flexible at 25%).

COMMON MISTAKES AT THIS STAGE

- Starting three streams at once
- Counting likes instead of euros
- Taking side hours from sleep or family

LILIANE'S TIP

- One stream, one test, one number.
- Track € per hour. Euros decide.
- Family hours first, side hours second.

STAGE 7 | MONTH 12 ONWARD | GOAL: LEVEL 6



Repeat, automate & buy back time

Pillar 5 · Time freedom & real life

This is what every other stage has been building towards. Money becomes time: fewer late nights, a day each week that belongs to your family, and being there for the moments that matter.

01
MAP YOUR REAL WEEK
In T · Time, fill in the 168 hours as they are now, including care, admin and recovery.

02
DRAW YOUR GOAL WEEK
Same table, the week you want. How many more family hours? How many fewer work hours?

03
PRICE THE GAP
The tracker shows what the work hours you want back are worth per year. That's your next income target.

04
TAKE THE FREE WINS FIRST
Stop unpaid overtime, batch errands, ask a sibling for a fixed care day. Many hours cost nothing to get back.

05
NEGOTIATE FLEXIBILITY
Remote days, compressed hours, a 4-day week, carer's leave or a sabbatical. Your Stage 2 win file is your evidence.

06
STEP DOWN IN STAGES
Reduce hours only when extra income covers the difference for 6 months in a row and your full fund is intact.

07
PROTECT WHAT YOU GAINED
Put family time in your calendar like a client meeting. Freed hours fill up fast if nobody guards them.

08
REACH LEVEL 6, YOUR WAY
Extra income covers your needs. Keep working, cut back, change direction. The difference is that now it's a choice.

HEAVY-WEEK VERSION

Protect one hour this week for someone you love. Phone off. That is the whole point of the plan.

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

T · Time: unplanned hours, family time gained per year, value of the work hours you want back.

✔ 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

✔ Look at “Family time gained / year” in T · Time. Write down what you'll do with the first of those hours.

STAGE 7 · DEEP DIVE

YOUR FREEDOM NUMBER

Put a number on your freedom

Know what a free day costs, and plan for it

Freedom becomes real when it has a number. Once you know what a free day each week costs, you can plan for it instead of only wishing for it.

YOUR FREEDOM NUMBERS

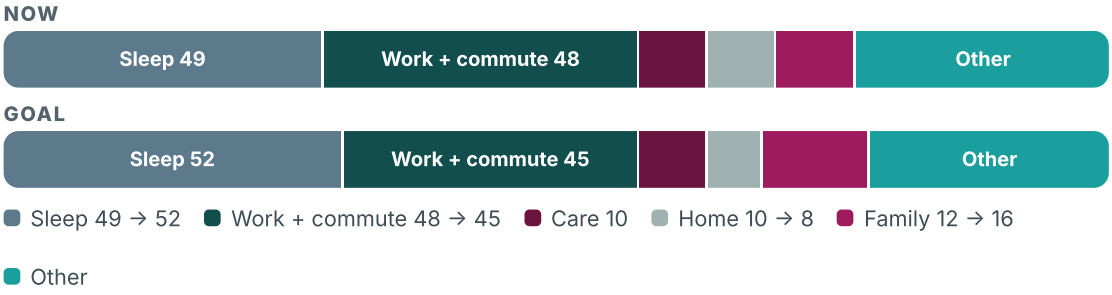
Baseline = your monthly needs × 12
e.g. €1,740 × 12 = €20,880 a year

One day a week back ≈ 20% of your net salary
e.g. 20% × €2,500 = €500 a month

Level 5 · Flexible = extra income ≥ 25% of needs
e.g. €435 a month

Level 6 · Free to choose = extra income ≥ needs
e.g. €1,740 a month

A WEEK HAS 168 HOURS · EXAMPLE, NOW VS GOAL



From the T · Time tab example: 4 more family hours a week is over 200 hours a year with the people you love.

84%

Of nearly 5 million people in need of care in Germany at the end of 2021, about 84% were cared for at home, mostly by family. If this is your life too, you are far from alone.

Destatis, care statistics (2022)

Time > things

People who spent money to buy themselves time, for example by paying for a chore they dislike, reported greater life satisfaction than those who spent it on material things.

Whillans et al., PNAS (2017)

✓ 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

✓ Write your baseline × 12 on a sticky note and put it on your fridge. That one number is your "enough": the amount that makes work a choice.

STAGE 7 · DEEP DIVE REPEAT

YOUR SYSTEM FOR THE LONG RUN

Weekly, monthly, yearly: the rhythm that lasts

Transformation doesn't come from one perfect month. It comes from a simple rhythm you repeat for years. Put these four appointments in your calendar now.

EVERY WEEK · 15 MIN

Money check

Look at what you keep, move this week's transfer, take the next step.

EVERY MONTH · 30 MIN

Review

Update Monthly Review, check your Freedom Level, write one win.

EVERY QUARTER · 1 HOUR

Reset

Cancel new leaks, review debt and goal pots, check your income stream.

EVERY YEAR · 2 HOURS

Raise your future

Salary review, raise your saving rate by 1–2 points, update your freedom numbers, review investments.

RAISE YOUR SAVING RATE BY 2 POINTS A YEAR · NET SALARY €2,500



Small steps you barely feel, especially when they come from raises, as in Save More Tomorrow. Over five years that's €15,000 saved, before any growth.

WHEN LIFE GETS IN THE WAY

Missed a week? Start again with the 2-minute check. One missed day doesn't break a habit.

Emergency used the fund? Pause investing, refill the buffer, then continue.

Income dropped? Go back to Stage 2 and rebuild your baseline. The system works at every level.

BOOK THEM NOW · 4 RECURRING APPOINTMENTS

1. Weekly: _____ (day) at _____ (time)
2. Monthly: the _____ of each month
3. Quarterly: January, April, July, October
4. Yearly money date: _____ (6–8 weeks before your salary review)

KEEP THE RHYTHM WHEN LIFE IS FULL

1. Every appointment has a 2-minute version
2. Move it, never delete it
3. The yearly date is the one never to skip
4. Do the monthly review with your partner, if you share costs

STAGE 7 · DEEP DIVE AUTOMATE

Automate everything you can

Decide once, then let the system carry you

The goal of Stage 7 is a money life that runs on its own while you spend your attention on the people you love. Every line you automate is one less decision on a tired evening.

WHAT	WHEN	HOW	DONE
Bills and needs	Payday	Standing orders and direct debits from your bills account	☐
Keep your first hour	Payday	Fixed transfer to your safety net, then to investing	☐
Debt extra	Payday	Fixed extra payment to Priority 1 until it is gone	☐
Goal pots	Day 2	One transfer per pot: gifts, care, holiday, car	☐
Investing	Day 2	A fixed monthly amount, reviewed once a year	☐
Side income split	When it arrives	Tax pot first, then investing and your time goal	☐
Saving rate +1–2 points	Every raise	Raise the transfers before your lifestyle notices	☐

YOUR YEARLY MONEY DATE · 2 HOURS

1. Salary review booked, win file ready
2. Saving and investing rate up 1–2 points
3. Freedom numbers updated
4. Investment costs and risk checked
5. Insurance and goal pots reviewed

LIFESTYLE CREEP CHECK

When your income rises, spending quietly rises with it. Once a year, compare your wants in T · Track with last year. If they grew faster than your keep rate, move the difference back to your future.

YOUR MONEY FLOW ON PAYDAY

Salary arrives in your main account › **Bills** needs and debt minimums leave automatically › **Safety net** your first hour, before anything else › **Investing** a fixed amount on day 2 › **Spending** what's left is yours, guilt-free

Four or five accounts sound complicated, but they make every decision automatic. Most banks let you open sub-accounts for free.

BEFORE YOU AUTOMATE

Pick a date 1–2 days after payday, so the salary has always arrived.

Start smaller than you think. Raise the amount after three months that worked.

Keep one month of needs in the bills account, so a late salary never bounces a payment.

STAGE 7 · YOUR TOOL BUY-BACK LIST

Your buy-back-time list

Price your time, then buy back the hours that matter most

Not every hour costs money to get back. Start with the free ones, then use your freedom numbers to decide which paid ones are worth it.

HOUR I WANT BACK	FREE OR PAID?	COST A MONTH	HOURS A MONTH GAINED	WHO GETS THAT TIME
Unpaid overtime	Free	€0	16	Family dinners
Weekly big shop instead of 4 small ones	Free	€0	4	Sunday walk
Cleaning help, every two weeks	Paid	€80	6	Time with mum

MONTHLY REVIEW · 30 MINUTES

1. KEEP this month: €_____ · keep rate _____% · Freedom Level _____
2. Safety net _____% · debt €_____ · invested this month €_____ · extra income €_____
3. One win, however small: _____
4. Hours I took back this month: _____ and who I spent them with: _____
5. Next month's single focus: _____

FREE HOURS TO TAKE BACK FIRST

1. Unpaid overtime: leave on time twice a week
2. Notifications off after 7 pm
3. One big shop instead of several small ones
4. Batch cooking on Sunday
5. Saying no to one meeting a week

PAID HELP WORTH CHECKING

1. Cleaning help every two weeks
2. Grocery delivery
3. A laundry service in heavy months
4. Care support, so you can be family, not only a carer
5. Childcare for one fixed afternoon

IS IT WORTH BUYING?

Cost a month ÷ hours gained a month = € per hour bought

e.g. €80 ÷ 6 hours = €13.33. If that's close to your real hourly value and the hours go to the people you love, it's usually worth it.

STAGE 7 · CHECKLIST DONE WHEN



Repeat, automate & buy back time · done when

Tick every box before you move on. Slow is fine. Skipping is what costs money.

Each box is something you can see, not something you feel. When all of them are ticked, write today's date here: _____.

- [ ] Every transfer in the automation table runs on its own.
- [ ] My monthly review happens, even in short form.
- [ ] I mapped my real week and my goal week in T · Time.
- [ ] I took back at least one free hour every week.
- [ ] My freedom numbers are written down.
- [ ] My yearly money date is in the calendar.

WRITE IT DOWN

1. The first hours I took back went to...
2. My Level 6 number (needs a month): €...
3. What "enough" looks like for me...

IN YOUR TRUST TRACKER PRO

T · Time: family time gained a year. Monthly Review: one row a month. The KEEP dashboard shows your level, and the 7 Stages tab shows 7 of 7.

NEXT STAGE UNLOCKS WHEN

There is no next stage. You repeat the cycle once a year, a little higher each time, until work is a choice (Level 6).

COMMON MISTAKES AT THIS STAGE

- Letting automation run without ever checking it
- Spending every freed-up hour on more work
- Forgetting to raise your saving rate

LILIANE'S TIP

- Check it monthly, change it yearly.
- Name who gets each hour you take back.
- Add 1–2 points with every raise.

YOUR YEAR AT A GLANCE

The 12-month plan

One focus a month. If life swallows a month, simply repeat it. A plan you can restart will always beat a perfect plan you abandon.

MONTH 1
Mindset & numbers
Money why, real hourly value, 2-hour setup, every euro sorted, one leak cut.

MONTH 2
Starter buffer
Separate account, standing transfers. Win file started.

MONTH 3
Debt order
Priority 1 chosen, lender called, no new debt. Skip if you have none.

MONTH 4
Raise prep
Market range researched, review booked, flexibility on the list too.

MONTH 5
Debt-free push
Roll payments forward. Aim for Level 3.

MONTH 6
Safety net
Fund target set, goal pots running, emergency rule written.

MONTH 7
Pick one stream
Contract and tax rules checked. One-page offer written.

MONTH 8
Learn investing
Employer pension checked, two-sentence test, costs understood.

MONTH 9
Full fund
3–6 months saved. Level 4: secure. 90-day test starts.

MONTH 10
Automate wealth
Fixed monthly investing amount on payday, if it suits your situation.

MONTH 11
Day-90 decision
Keep, change or stop the stream. Track € per hour.

MONTH 12
Time map
Real week vs goal week. Price the gap. Plan year two.

END OF MONTH 3
Checkpoint 1
Level 1 or 2. Keep rate known, win file running.

END OF MONTH 6
Checkpoint 2
Debt-free or close. Safety net growing.

END OF MONTH 9
Checkpoint 3
Level 4 · Secure. Investing set up.

END OF MONTH 12
Checkpoint 4
One stream tested. Time map done. Year two planned.

IF LIFE SWALLOWS A MONTH

Repeat it. The plan is 12 focus months, not 12 calendar months.

Keep the automation running, even if nothing else happens.

Most people need 12 to 18 months. Caring, illness and busy seasons are part of the plan, not a failure of it.

MY YEAR IN ONE SENTENCE

In 12 months, I want to be at Level _____, with _____ more hours a week for _____.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Seven traps for busy people, and the fix for each

TRAP	FIX
Waiting for a calm month. Busy people rarely get one, so the plan never begins.	Start with the 2-minute minimum. Momentum matters far more than perfection.
Investing before you have a buffer. The first emergency forces you to sell at the worst time.	Follow the ladder. Levels 2–4 come before long-term investing.
Five side hustles at once. Nothing gets enough hours to work, and you burn out.	One stream, one 90-day test, one number to watch.
Lifestyle creep. The raise or first side income vanishes into nicer everyday spending.	Give every new euro a job the day it arrives: buffer, debt, investing or time.
Trading family time for "future freedom". You build the life, and miss the people it was meant for.	Family hours are planned first, side hours second. T · Time keeps you honest.

TRAP · COMPARING YOURSELF ONLINE

Other people's highlights make your progress look small. **Fix:** compare only with your own Monthly Review from three months ago.

TRAP · DOING IT ALONE

Money stays a private worry and decisions stay hard. **Fix:** share your Freedom Level with one person you trust, or your partner, once a month.

MY TRAP PLAN

1. The trap I fall into most is... _____
2. The early sign I'll watch for is... _____
3. My fix, in one sentence: _____

✓ 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

✓ Read the seven traps again and circle the one you recognise most. Tell one person about it this week. A trap you can name is a trap you can avoid.

WORDS YOU'LL MEET

Your money glossary

Money talk is full of jargon, often on purpose. These are the only words you need for this roadmap, in plain language.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
Baseline	What your life really costs a month: your needs. The base of every freedom number.
Keep rate	What you keep divided by what comes in. The single best number to watch every week.
Real hourly value	Net pay divided by your real hours, including overtime and commute.
Keep your first hour	Paying your future the first hour of every workday, on payday, before anything else.
Starter buffer	One month of needs, saved before you attack debt.
Emergency fund	3–6 months of needs, separate and easy to reach. Insurance, not an investment.
Avalanche	Paying extra on the debt with the highest interest rate first.
Goal pot	A small monthly amount for a cost you know is coming: gifts, repairs, care.
Compound growth	Growth that earns growth of its own. Time is its strongest ingredient.
Inflation	Prices rising over time, so the same euro buys a little less each year.
Costs (TER)	What an investment charges every year, in percent.
€ per hour	What a side stream really pays for the time you put in.
Freedom Level	Seven levels from Overwhelmed to Free to choose. Your tracker works it out.
Freedom number	The extra income that would cover your needs, so work becomes a choice.
Net pay	What actually lands in your account after tax and social contributions.
Gross pay	Your salary before anything is taken off. The number in your contract.
Needs and wants	Needs keep your life running; wants make it nicer. Both are fine, as long as you know which is which.
Reclaim	Cutting, reducing or renegotiating a cost, and moving the difference to your future.
Standing order	An automatic transfer you set up once that runs on the same day every month.
Diversification	Spreading money across many investments so one failure can't sink you.
Index fund	A fund that follows a whole market instead of trying to pick winners.
Volatility	How much an investment's value goes up and down. Normal, and why you need time.
Lifestyle creep	Spending that quietly rises with every raise, until the raise is gone.

YOUR NEXT 24 HOURS

Start small. Start today.

You don't need to finish this roadmap this week. You only need to begin Stage 1. Here are your first five steps.

- [ ] Open TRUST Tracker Pro and read the About Me, How to Use and 7 Stages tabs (5 minutes).
- [ ] Add a recurring 15-minute weekly money check to your calendar.
- [ ] Write your money why in one sentence (Stage 1).
- [ ] Book your 2-hour setup session within the next 7 days.
- [ ] Cancel one subscription you don't use.
- [ ] Write one sentence about who you want more time with, and why.

STAY IN TOUCH

Share your Freedom Level wins with me on Instagram at **@cyber_cnslt**, and find more free tools at **cybercnslt.com**. I read every message, even when I can't answer them all.

Build your career. Build your wealth. Build your options.
— Liliane

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